

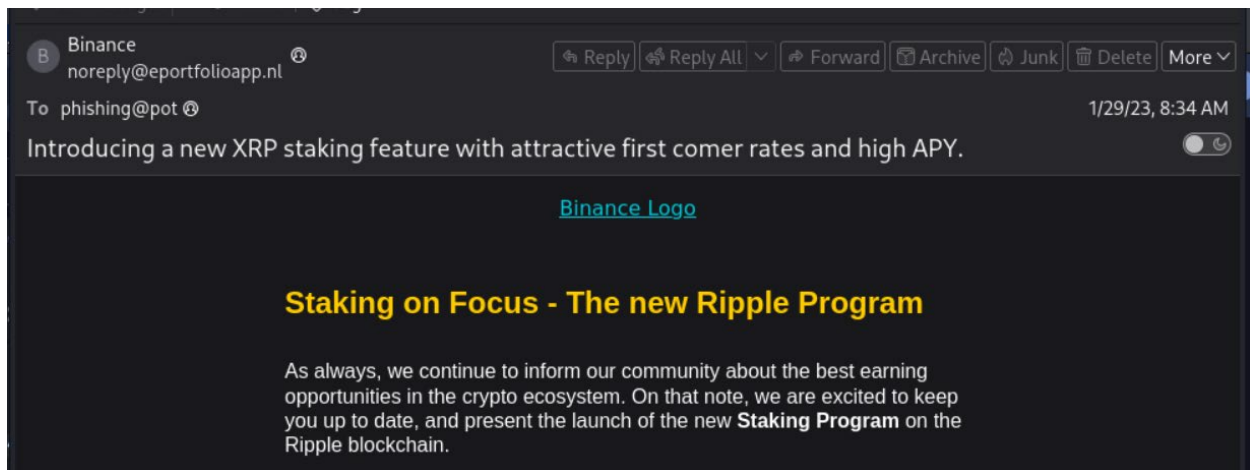
Phishing Email Forensic Simulation Report

1. Executive Summary

A suspicious email received through the company email system was analyzed using email header analysis, URL inspection, and threat intelligence tools. The investigation identified suspicious links commonly used in phishing attacks.

One shortened URL redirected users to another external website that was flagged by multiple security vendors as phishing and malicious. Additional indicators, including missing DMARC protection and mismatched email routing information, further confirmed suspicious activity.

Based on the findings, the email is assessed as a phishing attempt intended to trick users into clicking malicious links.



2. Email Body URL and Attachment Analysis

a) Embedded Suspicious URLs

Two URLs were identified in the email:

- <http://bit.ly/3IR0iq3?575504>
 - Redirected to: <https://ripple.com.gt/insights/staking-program/>
- <https://eportfolioapp.nl/?plbms406qayn72wwk3r6cxcxc0xc0svab>

The URLs were analyzed using:

- URLScan.io
- VirusTotal

Introducing a new XRP staking feature with attractive first comer rates and high APY.

immediately deliver an **exceptional up to 31% ROI** and **additional incentive premiums** for those that apply and qualify in the annual staking run.

How does it work?

Initially, **only a few thousand eligible** participants will be able to take part in the first staking 'lap'. Eligibility is determined by Ripple internal algorithms and includes several factors - ability to cover the required minimum XRP balance, having a self custodial wallet that is compatible with the Program, account age and on-chain activity.

Earn by Staking XRP <http://bit.ly/3IR0iq3?575504>

Stay Connected!

Risk warning: Cryptocurrency is subject to high market risk. Binance will make the best efforts to choose high-quality coins, but will not be responsible for your decisions. Please act with caution.

Kindly note: Please be aware of phishing sites and always make sure you are visiting the official Binance.com website when entering sensitive data.

Manage your email preferences [here](#).

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<https://eportfolioapp.nl/?plbms406qayn72wwk3r6cxc0xc0svab>

b) Threat Intelligence Results

URLScan.io Findings

- No malicious classification was detected for the Bit.ly URL.
- The shortened URL acted as a redirect link, which is commonly used by threat actors to hide the final destination.

bit.ly
67.199.248.11 **Public Scan**

🔍 Lookup ↗ Go To ↻ Rescan

🗨 Add Verdict 📄 Report

Submitted URL:
<http://bit.ly/3IR0iq3?575504> 🕒 13yr old

Effective URL:
<https://bit.ly/3IR0iq3?575504> 🕒 13yr old

Submission: On May 15 via manual (May 15th 2026, 5:16:45 am UTC) from — Scanned from

🏠 Summary 🔄 HTTP 24 ➡ Redirects 🔗 Links 20 💬 Behaviour ⚙ Indicators 🔍 Similar 📄 DOM 📄 Content 📄 API

Summary

This website contacted 5 IPs in 1 countries across 5 domains to perform 24 HTTP transactions. The main IP is 67.199.248.11, located in United States and belongs to **GOOGLE-CLOUD-PLATFORM - Google LLC, US**. The main domain is **bit.ly**. The Cisco Umbrella rank of the primary domain is 6407. 🕒 13yr old

TLS certificate: Issued by Amazon RSA 2048 M01 on February 24th 2026. Valid for: 7mo.

[bit.ly](#) scanned 10000+ times on urlscan.io [Show Scans 10000+](#)

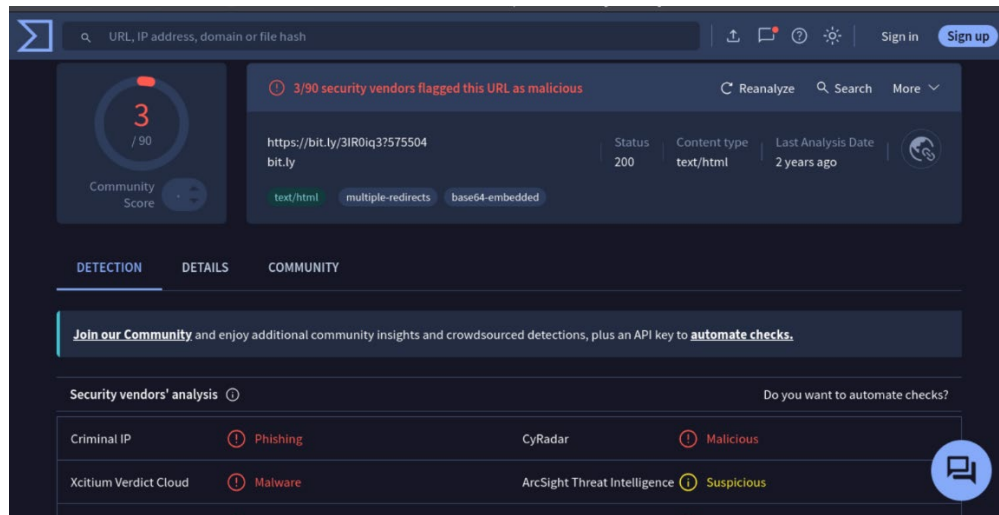
urlscan.io Verdict: No classification ✅

Live information

Google Safe Browsing: ✅ No classification for [bit.ly](#)

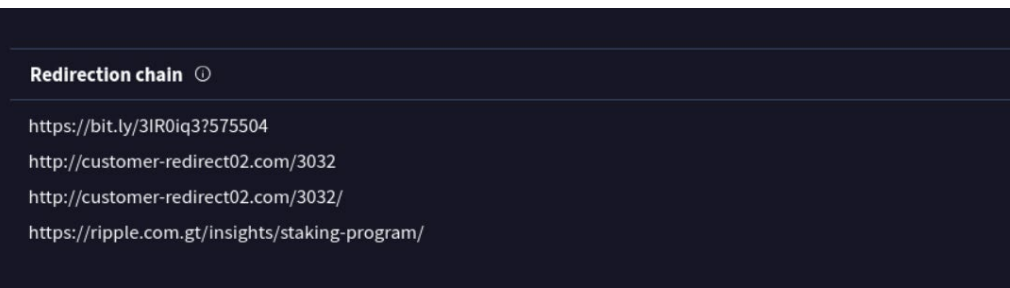
Screenshot

VirusTotal Findings



The screenshot shows the VirusTotal interface for the URL `https://bit.ly/3IR0iq3?575504`. The Community Score is 3/90. A warning states: "3/90 security vendors flagged this URL as malicious". The status is 200, content type is text/html, and it was last analyzed 2 years ago. Metadata includes `text/html`, `multiple-redirects`, and `base64-embedded`. The "DETECTION" tab is active, showing a message to join the community and a table of security vendors' analysis.

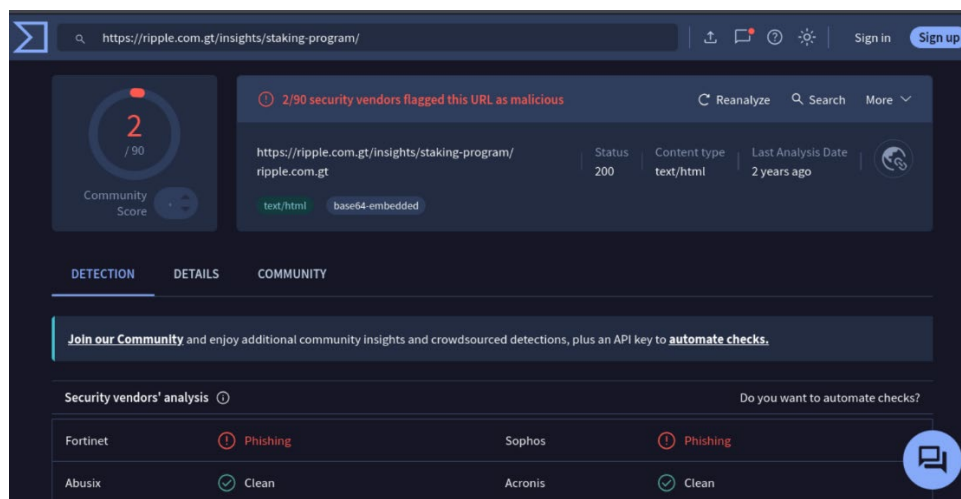
Security vendors' analysis		Do you want to automate checks?	
Criminal IP	Phishing	CyRadar	Malicious
Xcition Verdict Cloud	Malware	ArcSight Threat Intelligence	Suspicious



The "Redirection chain" section shows the following sequence of URLs:

- `https://bit.ly/3IR0iq3?575504`
- `http://customer-redirect02.com/3032`
- `http://customer-redirect02.com/3032/`
- `https://ripple.com.gt/insights/staking-program/`

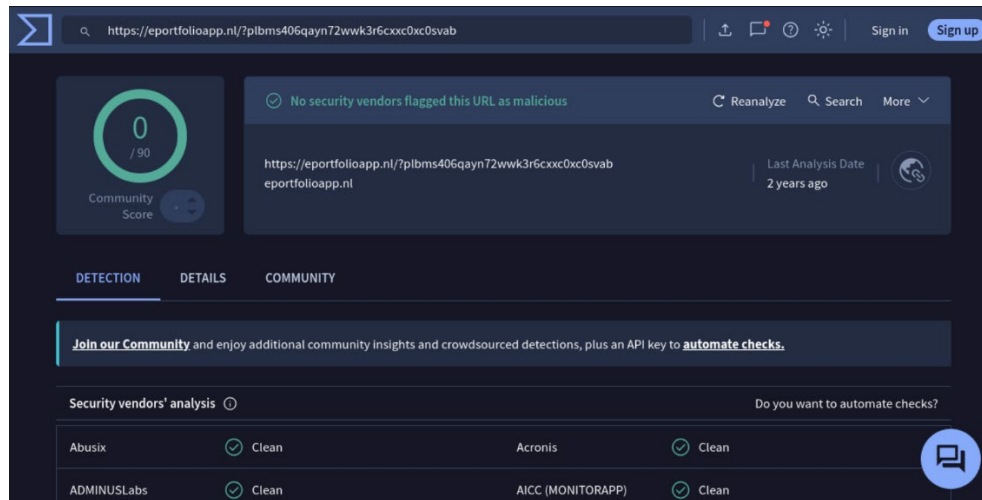
- The Bit.ly redirect URL was flagged by multiple security vendors as:
 - Phishing
 - Malicious
 - Malware-related
- The redirected final URL was also flagged by security vendors as phishing.



The screenshot shows the VirusTotal interface for the URL `https://ripple.com.gt/insights/staking-program/`. The Community Score is 2/90. A warning states: "2/90 security vendors flagged this URL as malicious". The status is 200, content type is text/html, and it was last analyzed 2 years ago. Metadata includes `text/html` and `base64-embedded`. The "DETECTION" tab is active, showing a message to join the community and a table of security vendors' analysis.

Security vendors' analysis		Do you want to automate checks?	
Fortinet	Phishing	Sophos	Phishing
Abusix	Clean	Acronis	Clean

- The second URL shared the same domain as the sender's email address (eportfolioapp.nl).
- No vendors flagged this domain as malicious, but its use in the email remains suspicious.



c) Attachment Analysis

No attachment was included in the email; therefore, no attachment analysis was performed.

3. Email Header Analysis

Further analysis was performed on the email header to identify additional phishing indicators.

a) Sender Information

- Sender IP Address: 167.89.89.163
- Sender Email Address: Binance <noreply@eportfolioapp.nl>
- SPF: Pass
- DKIM: Pass
- DMARC: None
- SMTP Server: sendgrid.net
- Return-Path: @sendgrid.net

The email was sent using SendGrid mail infrastructure.

```

12 cipher=TLS ECDHE_RSA WITH AES 256 GCM SHA384) id 15.20.6043.33 via Frontend
13 Transport; Sun, 29 Jan 2023 13:34:03 +0000
14 Authentication-Results: spf=pass (sender IP is 167.89.89.163)
15 smtp.mailfrom=sendgrid.net; dkim=pass (signature was verified)
16 header.d=sendgrid.net; dmarc=none action=none header.from=eportfolioapp.nl;
17 Received-SPF: Pass (protection.outlook.com: domain of sendgrid.net designates
18 167.89.89.163 as permitted sender) receiver=protection.outlook.com;
19 client-ip=167.89.89.163; helo=xtrwrwxp.outbound-mail.sendgrid.net; pr=C
20 Received: from xtrwrwxp.outbound-mail.sendgrid.net (167.89.89.163) by
21 BN8NAM12FT092.mail.protection.outlook.com (10.13.182.110) with Microsoft SMTP
22 Server (version=TLS1_2, cipher=TLS ECDHE_RSA WITH AES 256 GCM SHA384) id
23 15.20.6064.17 via Frontend Transport; Sun, 29 Jan 2023 13:34:02 +0000
24 X-IncomingTopHeaderMarker:
25

```

b) IP Reputation Check

VirusTotal / WHOIS Results

- The IP address belongs to SendGrid.
- No major security vendor flagged the IP as malicious.

Basic Properties

- Network: 167.89.64.0/19
- Autonomous System Number...: 11377
- Autonomous System Label: SendGrid, Inc.
- Regional Internet Registry: ARIN
- Country: US
- Continent: NA

Whois Lookup

- NetRange: 167.89.0.0 - 167.89.127.255
- CIDR: 167.89.0.0/17
- NetName: SENDGRID-167-89-0-17
- NetHandle: NET-167-89-0-0-1
- Parent: NET167 (NET-167-0-0-0-0)
- NetType: Direct Allocation
- OriginAS: AS11377
- Organization: SendGrid, Inc. (SENDG-12)
- RegDate: 2013-10-31
- Updated: 2016-11-11
- Comment: <http://www.sendgrid.com>
- Comment: Standard Support Hours - 7am - 7pm PST

AbuseIPDB Results

- The IP address was previously reported for spam and phishing-related activity.
- This indicates the IP may have been used in previous phishing campaigns.

AbuseIPDB Report IP Bulk Checker Bulk Reporter Pricing Integrations Docs IP Utilities Contact More

ISP: SendGrid, Inc.

Usage Type: Commercial

ASN: [AS11377](#)

Hostname(s): o1.ptl2983.uonline.com

Domain Name: twilio.com

Country: United States of America

City: Leesburg, Virginia

IP info including ISP, Usage Type, and Location provided by IPInfo. Updated weekly.

[REPORT 167.89.89.163](#) [WHOIS 167.89.89.163](#)

IP Abuse Reports for 167.89.89.163:

This IP address has been reported a total of 1 time from 1 distinct source. It was most recently reported 3 years ago.

Old Reports: The most recent abuse report for this IP address is from 3 years ago. It is possible that this IP is no longer involved in abusive activities.

Reporter	IoA Timestamp (UTC)	Comment	Categories
✓ Anonymous	2023-04-04 05:32:25 (3 years ago)	Spam/Phishing sender with links to em1953.restaurants.lieferando.at	Phishing Web Spam Email Spam

c) Email Authentication Results

SPF (Sender Policy Framework): PASS

- The sending server was authorized to send emails on behalf of the domain.
- However, SPF alone does not confirm the email is safe.

DKIM (DomainKeys Identified Mail): PASS

- The email contained a valid DKIM signature.
- This confirms the message was signed by the sending domain.

DMARC (Domain-based Message Authentication, Reporting, and Conformance): NONE

- No DMARC policy was configured for the domain.
- This increases the risk of spoofed or unauthorized emails.

d) Send and Return Path Analysis

The email showed inconsistencies between:

- Sender email address
- Sending server
- Return-Path information

These mismatches are common indicators of phishing emails.

```
34      2023-01-29 13:34:02.161069844 +0000 UTC m=+62/2909.96945/568
35 Received: from MjMyMDM1NQ (unknown)
36      by geopod-ismtpd-2-1 (SG) with HTTP
37      id bTSWq6rGQt0Sc34XLwDgG
38      Sun, 29 Jan 2023 13:34:02.104 +0000 (UTC)
39 Content-Transfer-Encoding: quoted-printable
40 Content-Type: text/html; charset=utf-8
41 Date: Sun, 29 Jan 2023 13:34:02 +0000 (UTC)
42 From: Binance <noreply@portfolioapp.nl>
43 Message-ID: <bTSWq6rGQt0Sc34XLwDgG@geopod-ismtpd-2-1>
44 Subject: Introducing a new XRP staking feature with attractive first comer
45 rates and high APY.
46 X-SG-EID:
47 =?us-ascii?Q?8Fc7yDYK2TDbV0IhkKyhe0YD6LJtEdS2PQG3+6x3l0BJpnhkpkazDh9yTU=2F90y?=
48 =?us-ascii?Q?Rq2kq4eSK6doIHQiyTsNBK2G18pc0cBoTxx5cCT?=
49 =?us-ascii?Q?8Bm4s810uUU5Gdh7oyJZ+l6Xu6k92cmIkLLvm2p?=
50 =?us-ascii?Q?DhUftYTtmVJIWYHaV4J7EGunCAXxEFmmiQhRMGs?=
51 =?us-ascii?Q?jesYlM+NSWyI5RcJaLhwWzsZr36AWvpICwLtm6W?=
52 =?us-ascii?Q?me=2Fm1cgf=2F20iRWcWhU=2FDuTw57JNna1i1Z1vPJ9?=
53 X-SG-ID:
54 =?us-ascii?Q?N2C25iY2uzGMFz6rgv0sb8raWjw0ZPf1VmjsCkspi=2FJw82+F8wc1PSuyZ8dCFT?=
55 =?us-ascii?Q?4+ypu4PxSq+cUKum1q5ZYuA=3D=3D?=
56 To: phishing@pot
57 X-Entity-ID: iFhAKeuY+S48BtVTsmMIGA==
58 X-IncomingHeaderCount: 14
59 Return-Path: bounces+2320355-5307-phishing@pot=hotmail.com@sendgrid.net
60 X-MS-Exchange-Organization-ExpirationStartTime: 29 Jan 2023 13:34:03.0974
```

4. Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

- Suspicious embedded URLs
- Redirect links hiding the final destination
- Missing DMARC protection
- Mismatched sender and return-path information
- Previously reported phishing-related IP activity

5. Conclusion

The email is confirmed to be a phishing attempt. The message used suspicious redirect links, hidden destinations, and unusual email routing behavior commonly seen in phishing attacks.

Threat intelligence scans identified the embedded URLs as phishing and malicious. Although SPF and DKIM checks passed, the lack of DMARC protection and suspicious routing information increased the likelihood of malicious intent.

6. Recommendations

1. Remove and quarantine the email from all user inboxes.
2. Block the identified malicious URLs and related domains on firewalls, proxies, DNS filters, and email gateways.
3. Monitor logs and endpoint activity to identify users who may have clicked the links.
4. Strengthen email security by enforcing DMARC policies in addition to SPF and DKIM validation.
5. Conduct phishing awareness training for employees.
6. Report the phishing indicators to Microsoft Security, APWG, and Google Safe Browsing.
7. Continue monitoring for similar phishing emails using related domains or infrastructure.

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